

Appendix A

Annotation Guideline

A.1 Task Description

In this task you are asked to annotate metaphors in blog texts from Kanker.nl. The goal is to identify and annotate all metaphorical expressions in the texts. Please apply the metaphor theory described in the Theory section and follow the annotation procedure outlined in the Procedure section.

A.2 Theory

This annotation guide uses a combination of the Conceptual Metaphor Theory (CMT) and the Metaphor Identification Procedure Vrije Universiteit (MIPVU) as a basis. According to CMT, metaphors are not merely stylistic but reflect underlying conceptual mappings between a source domain and a target domain. These mappings allow people to understand abstract concepts in terms of more concrete and familiar experiences. Metaphorical expressions are the linguistic realizations of these conceptual mappings and can appear as individual words or phrases. An example of such a conceptual mapping is *CANCER IS WAR* where *CANCER* is the target domain and *WAR* is the source domain. The sentence *Ik geef me niet over aan deze ziekte* (*I will not surrender to this disease*) shows a great example of how such a mapping results in a metaphorical expression as the disease is seen as an opponent.

A.2.1 Types of metaphors

Being aware of different metaphor types can be helpful during annotation. The types of metaphors described in the Conceptual Metaphor Theory are outlined below. In the examples, the metaphorical parts are shown in italics.

Structural metaphors

Structural metaphors are those in which one concept is understood and experienced in terms of another. Structural metaphors give structure to our understanding of abstract concepts, by mapping them into more concrete and familiar domains. These metaphors do not imply that the target domain is literally the source domain but that certain characteristics or behaviours of the source domain can be applied to the target.

Examples:

De behandeling was een zware strijd. (KANKER IS OORLOG)

The treatment was a heavy battle. (CANCER IS WAR)

Ik heb een lange weg afgelegd. (LEVEN IS EEN REIS)

I have come a long way. (LIFE IS A JOURNEY)

Mijn geheugen hapert de laatste tijd. (LICHAM IS EEN MACHINE)

My memory is failing lately. (BODY IS A MACHINE)

Orientational metaphors

Orientational metaphors organize a system of concepts with respect to one another. These metaphors typically rely on spatial orientation and arise from our physical experience of the world and the way our bodies relate to space and movement. A simple example are the mappings HAPPY IS UP and SAD IS DOWN. These mappings are based on physical experiences, where positive emotions tend to be associated with an upright expanded posture and negative emotions with a slumped, contracted one.

Examples:

Mijn stemming ging omhoog.

My mood went up.

Ik zakte weg in sombere gedachten.

I sank into gloomy thoughts.

De emoties kwamen weer naar boven.

The emotions resurfaced.

Ontological metaphors

Ontological metaphors help us understand abstract concepts and experiences in terms of concrete, physical objects. By conceptualizing something abstract as an entity or substance, we can more easily think about it, quantify it, and reason about it. These metaphors allow us to make sense of the intangible and to treat it as though it were a discrete thing, something we can interact with more directly.

Examples

Ik draag veel verdriet met me mee.

I carry a lot of sadness with me.

Dit was een zware dag.

It was a heavy day.

De angst nam toe.

The fear increased.

Container metaphors

Container metaphors are, like orientational metaphors, inspired by how we perceive our physical surroundings and experiences. As humans we see ourselves as containers with defined boundaries, and the rest of the world exists outside of us. This creates an in-out orientation which we also apply to other physical objects even if there is no natural physical boundary. By creating a boundary we can quantify things and measure objects in terms of the substance they contain.

Examples

Ik zit in een moeilijke periode.

I am in a difficult period.

Ik zit vol hoop.

I am full of hope.

Ik kwam uit een diep dal.

I came out of a deep valley.

Personification

Personification takes the ontological metaphors a step further by describing a concept in terms of a person.

Examples:

De ziekte achtervolgt me.

The disease is chasing me.

Mijn lichaam laat me in de steek.

My body is letting me down.

De ziekte bepaalde alles.

The disease determined everything.

It is very important to note that both orientational metaphors and ontological metaphors are so natural in our thought that they are usually understood as direct descriptions. Please be mindful of these types of metaphors during the annotation process.

A.2.2 Identifying Metaphorical Lexical Units

While CMT explains what metaphors are and how they function conceptually, it does not provide a systematic procedure for identifying metaphors in texts. For this reason, this study uses MIPVU as a starting point for annotation. MIPVU determines whether a lexical unit (a word) is metaphorically used by comparing its contextual meaning with its more basic meaning.

Determining meaning

The online Van Dale dictionary may be used to determine the definition of a word. Please note that dictionaries are limited and may not always include the contextual meaning of the word.

When consulting the dictionary, ensure that only the relevant word class is considered. If a word can function as both a noun and a verb, only consider the definitions that match the usage in the text.

Basic definition

The basic definition of a word is typically more concrete, physical, or historically older. Note that the most frequently used definition is not necessarily the most basic. Sometimes multiple definitions in the library can be considered equally basic. In these cases there is often an underlying definition that connects the definitions.

Example

"Dit was een zware dag." (This was a heavy day.)

A few definitions of *zwaar* (heavy) according to the Van Dale:

1. Onderworpen aan de zwaartekracht, een (bep.) gewicht hebbend
Having weight due to gravity
2. Betrekkelijk veel wegend
Weighing relatively much
3. Veel wegend door een grote omvang
Weighing a lot due to its large size
4. Omvangrijk, groot, aanzienlijk
Extensive, large, significant
5. Een psychisch gevoel van druk gevend
Causing psychological burden

It can be difficult to choose 1 basic definition. Definitions 1-4 all refer to a physical description of weight, which can thus be seen as the basic definition of the word. Definition 5 refers to a psychological experience and is the contextual meaning in this case. There is thus a substantial difference between the basic definition (a physical description of weight) and the contextual definition (a psychological feeling of pressure). We can thus conclude that the sentence contains a metaphor.

Contrasting definitions

When annotating metaphors, we look for words where the basic and contextual definition are sufficiently distinct, while still having a clear connection. This relationship can be clearly seen in the example above: both definitions refer to a certain form of weight or pressure, but in the contextual meaning the word refers to a specific psychological feeling. So even though the basic meaning and contextual meaning differ, there is still an underlying connection. Because of this we can classify it as a metaphor.

Determining whether the basic and contextual meaning are both distinct and related enough can sometimes be challenging. In such cases, it may be helpful to refer to the types of metaphors in [A.2.1](#). These categories are often easier to recognise and can support the annotation process.

A.2.3 Identifying metaphorical phrases

The initial annotation phase (Step 2 in [A.3](#)) takes place at the level of individual lexical units. However, metaphorical meaning is not always fully expressed by a single word. In many cases, a metaphor only becomes meaningful when the metaphorically used word is interpreted together with surrounding words. Therefore, the second annotation phase (Step 3 in [A.3](#)) asks the annotators to identify the minimal phrase required to express the metaphorical meaning.

Example

"Wat dat betreft kan ik weer opgelucht ademhalen" (In that regard, I can finally breathe a sigh of relief again.)

The first phase will only mark *ademhalen* as a metaphor. The second phase should then also mark *opgelucht* as part of the metaphor resulting in *opgelucht ademhalen* as being a metaphor in this sentence.

When relevant words are not adjacent, all intervening words must also be included. Articles, personal pronouns and possessive pronouns are included if they are grammatically part of that phrase.

Example

"En wil echt mijn vrijheid niet weer afgeven." (And do not want to give up my freedom again.)

In the first phase, *afgeven* is annotated. The second phase also annotates *vrijheid* as a part of the metaphor. As the two words are not directly next to each other, all intervening words are included resulting in *vrijheid niet weer afgeven*. Finally the possessive pronoun *mijn* is included resulting in the final metaphorical phrase *mijn vrijheid niet weer afgeven*.

In some cases references to the target domain must be included to make the metaphor complete.

Example

"De behandeling was een zware strijd." (The treatment was a heavy battle.)

In the first phase *zware* and *strijd* are annotated. In the second phase *behandeling* is annotated as *zware strijd* refers to *behandeling* and the metaphorical expression only then becomes apparent. Again, intervening words are also annotated as the words are not directly adjacent. Including the article leaves us with the final metaphorical phrase *De behandeling was een zware strijd*.

A.3 Procedure

Step 1: Read the text

Read the entire text carefully to understand its meaning and context before starting the annotation

Step 2: Identify metaphorically used lexical units

For each lexical unit:

1. Determine the meaning in context.
2. Determine if it has a more basic meaning.
3. Decide if the basic meaning contrasts with the contextual meaning.

Separable Complex Verbs (SCVs) should be seen as single lexical units. SCVs are words that consists of two components that are split up in a sentence like *ingaan* and *omdraaien*.

Refer to [A.2.1](#) and [A.2.2](#) if needed.

Step 3: Identify metaphorical phrases

For each lexical unit identified in Step 2:

1. Determine which words are necessary for the metaphorical interpretation, including possible references to the target domain.
2. Extend the annotation to the smallest phrase that expresses the metaphorical meaning.
3. If words are not adjacent, include all intervening words.
4. Include articles, personal pronouns, and possessive pronouns that are grammatically part of the phrase.

Refer to [A.2.3](#) if needed.